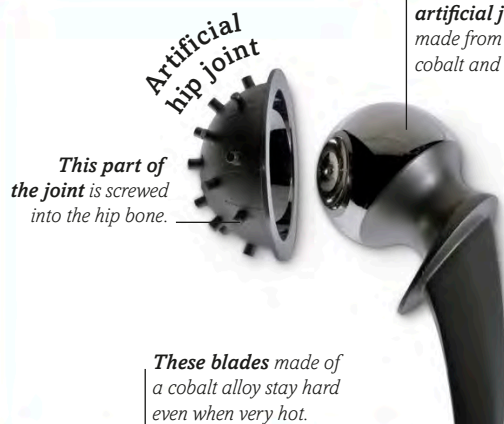
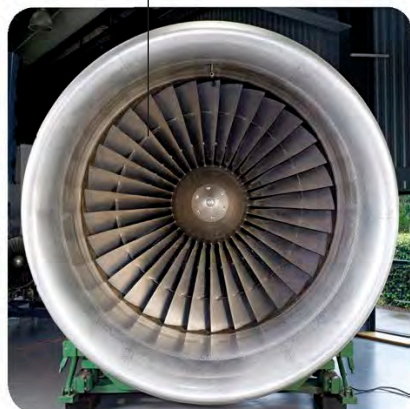
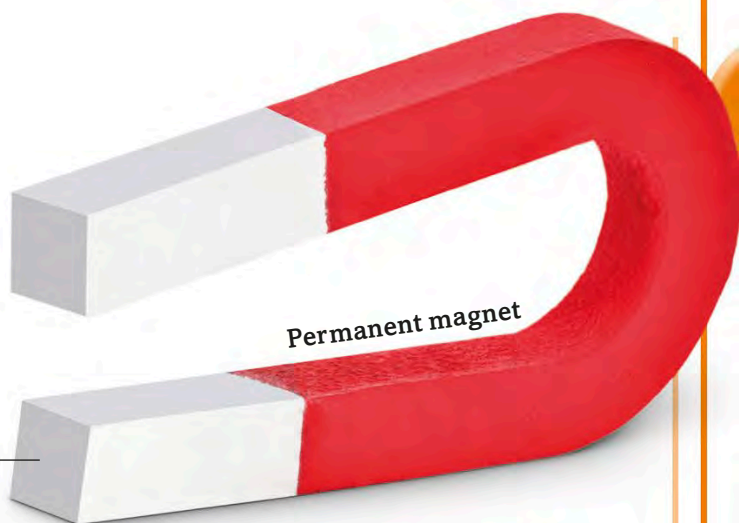


Uses



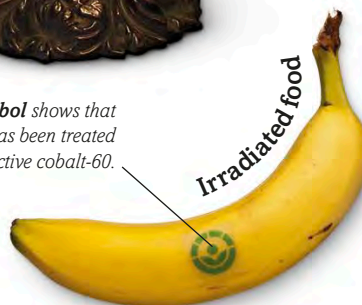
This magnet can work at temperatures as high as 800°C (1,400°F).



Cobalt blue paints have been in use **since 3000 BCE.**



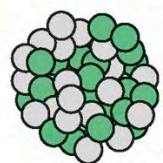
This symbol shows that this fruit has been treated with radioactive cobalt-60.



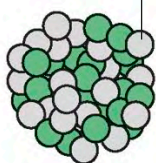
FORMING AN ISOTOPE

Cobalt-60 is an isotope, or form, of this element. It is created artificially in nuclear reactors. Because of its radioactivity, it is useful in some cancer treatments.

A neutron is fired at the cobalt-59 nucleus.



Added neutron



that can be used to make a permanent magnet. Large **permanent magnets** are made from a tough alloy of cobalt, nickel, and aluminium, called alnico. A radioactive form of cobalt, called cobalt-60, is produced in nuclear reactors. This form is widely

employed to **irradiate food**, a process by which food is exposed to a tiny dose of radiation to kill harmful germs. Cobalt can also produce a deep shade of blue: **cobalt blue paints** and dyes are formed by reacting aluminium with cobalt oxide.